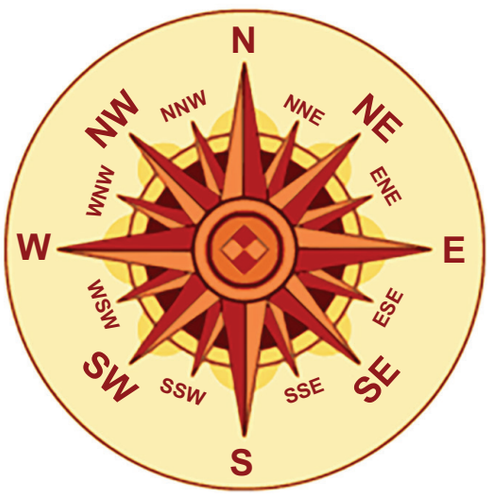
d. Direction

A map must indicate direction. This is done by means of an arrow pointing to the north. Once the north is located, it is easy to find the rest of the directions. Directions on a map are often given with symbol called a compass rose, which always shows north. Sometimes all the Cardinal directions such as north, south, east and west are shown. In addition the Intermediate directions of north east, north west, south east and south west may be given.



e. Source

All maps must show the source of the data used in the respective maps. The source should normally be given outside the frame of the map on the bottom right. On the bottom left the name of the author, publisher, place of publication and year of publication must be given.

f. Map Projection and locational information

A map projection is a way of representing the spherical earth on a flat surface of a map. The curved surface of the earth cannot be shown accurately on a map. So, cartographers use map projections while mapping the earth surface which would help them to reduce distortions. Latitudes and longitudes marked on maps give the locational information of the area covered in the respective maps.

g. Coventional signs and symbols

Conventional signs are symbols used in maps to represent different features. The symbols are explained in the key of the map. These symbols give a lot of information in a limited space. With the use of these symbols, maps can be drawn easily and the concept of the map can be understood well. There is an International agreement regarding the use of certain symbols. The symbols fall under this category are Called Conventional Symbols. Other category is called contextual symbols which are decided by the cartographers.

	Battlefield		Motorway Junction
	Bus Station		Railway Line
	Bridge	PH	Public House
	Camp Site		Public Telephone
50	Contour Lines		Radio or TV Mast
	Footpath		Power Line
	Lighthouse in Use	B 5132	Scondary Road
H	Helliport		View Point
	Information Centre		Windmill
A 41 (T)	Main Road	P	Parking

Types of Maps

Maps are classified on several basis. Each basis gives a different types of maps. In this lesson, we will learn about the nature and characteristics of Relief maps, Cadastral maps and Thematic Maps

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